🍲 Roux & Mirepoix: Reading · ANSWER KEY

Culinary 1 · Unit 7 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Roux & Mirepoix (plus the Mother Sauces PowerPoint)

Name: _____

Roux, Mirepoix and Sauces

A roux is equal parts fat and flour cooked together. It is used to make soups and sauces thick. To make one, melt butter on low, whisk in the flour, cook until smooth and bubbly, then slowly whisk in the liquid.

The longer a roux cooks, the darker and nuttier it gets. A white roux cooks 3 to 5 minutes, a blond roux 5 to 6 minutes, and a brown roux 15 to 20 minutes. A darker roux has more flavor but thickens less. Another thickener is a slurry: cornstarch mixed with cold water.

Mirepoix is a mix of chopped onion, celery and carrot (usually 2 parts onion to 1 part celery and 1 part carrot). It is cooked slowly in fat to build the flavor base for soups, stocks and sauces.

There are five mother sauces. Béchamel is milk with a white roux. Velouté is white stock with a blond roux. Espagnole is brown stock with a brown roux. Tomato sauce is made from tomatoes. Hollandaise is butter and egg yolk.

Milk can scorch, or burn on the bottom of the pan, so cook cream soups on medium-low heat and stir often.

Check your reading

1. What is a roux and what does it do?
Equal parts fat and flour cooked together; it thickens soups and sauces.

2. What three vegetables are in mirepoix?
Onion, celery and carrot.

3. Name two mother sauces and what they are made with.
Any two: béchamel (milk + white roux), velouté (white stock + blond roux), espagnole (brown stock + brown roux), tomato (tomatoes), hollandaise (butter + egg yolk).